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From the Simla Summit to Zia's Coup

Bhutto was clever enough to know just how badly Pakistan had been beaten and how weak it really was, despite the brave words he used in trying to lift the spirits of his defeated countrymen. But he also knew that the fortunes and destinies of nations often change quickly, and that in some respects losing Bangladesh was a great advantage for Pakistan. Though the country's eastern wing's exports of jute had earned most of Pakistan's hard currency during their decades linked together, its ten million Hindus had always seemed to Bhutto a potential fifth column, and, indeed, all Bengalis seemed less than trustworthy to him, more like Indians than true Pakistanis, most of whom were tougher, "real" Muslims.

Bhutto decided first of all to try to convince Indira Gandhi to agree to a peace treaty to reassure his generals that India would be no further immediate problem for them, and if possible to remove the continuing conflict over Kashmir from their troubled minds. He also resolved now to work on building atomic bombs and trying to acquire the technology needed to deliver them with Pakistan's own missiles. That April, he ended martial law and announced his intention to "bring back the rule of law" to Pakistan, as a prelude to his courtship of Indira Gandhi at their Summit Peace Conference in Simla, scheduled for June 1972.

Bhutto brought his daughter Benazir to the summit among his entourage of ninety-two PPP followers and government officials. Indira Gandhi greeted them at Simla's eagle-perch airport as they stepped out of the Soviet helicopter that flew them up from Lahore. Their summit